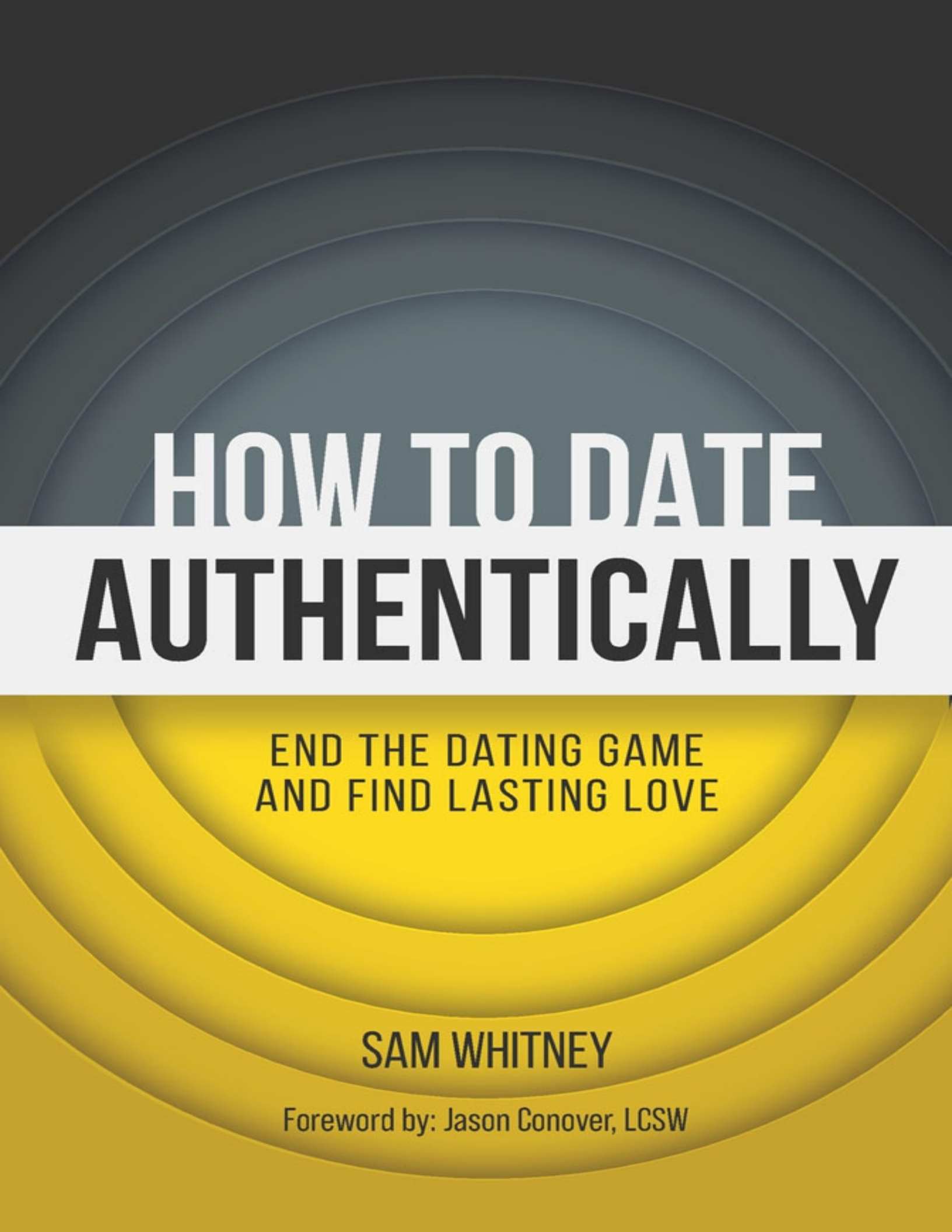




HOW TO DATE AUTHENTICALLY

END THE DATING GAME
AND FIND LASTING LOVE

SAM WHITNEY

Foreword by: Jason Conover, LCSW

How to Date Authentically: End the Dating Game and Find Lasting Love

By Sam Whitney

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Appendix:

Questions to Ask on a Date/Becoming a Better Listener

Here are some questions that you can use when on a date to put you in the listening seat and give you greater insight into those you're dating. You might use one or two of these to kick off a conversation. You could also make a date of asking all 20 questions. Whatever you choose to do, these questions are here to help you develop the habit of listening.

1. What is something good that has happened to you lately?
 - o. Why are you excited about it?
 - o. What does it mean for your future?
2. If I could give you a billion dollars, what would you do with it?
 - o. What experiences have you had that influenced why you said what you did?
3. What are some qualities that you admire in other people?
 - o. How about in yourself?
 - o. Tell me more about that.
4. What is something that you wish other people would recognize about you?
 - o. Why do you think they don't?
5. Can you tell me about when you had the most fun you've ever had?
 - o. Why was it so much fun for you?

6. If you could travel the world with one person from history, who would it be and why?
 - o. Where would you go on your trip?
7. Do you have a best friend?
 - o. Why is this person your best friend?
8. What did you want to be when you were little?
 - o. How does your life path now match that little person's dreams?
9. What is something you worry about?
10. What do you find yourself thinking about when you have free time?
 - o. Why do you think that is coming up for you?
11. What is something about you that you think others would find embarrassing?
12. Have you ever had your heart broken?
 - o. If you're willing to share, how has that experience shaped you?
13. Tell me about your parents. What are they like?
 - o. What about them do you hope you can keep doing?
 - o. What about them do you hope not to repeat?
14. Have you ever eaten anything that changed your life?
15. What is your go-to memory when you want to feel happy?
 - o. Why this memory?
16. What would you consider to be the biggest adventure you have had in your life so far?
17. If you had to leave lessons behind for future generations, what would they be?
 - o. What experiences have you had that make you say what you said?
18. If your life were a telenovela, what would you include as the weird twist?
19. What do you hope to accomplish with your dating journey?
20. If you could solve one world problem right now, what would it be and why?

Tips for Being Straightforward and Honest:

The following are ideas or prompts to help you get started with having 3 kinds of conversations that you might need to have:

1. Telling someone you like them.

2. Breaking up with someone.
3. Letting someone down who likes you.

Please take these with a massive grain of salt and keep in mind that they are just ideas. You ultimately get to choose who you approach and what is the best way to go about it.

It is important to keep in mind that what others will respond to most is not what you say, or even how you say it, but your deeper motivations. If you are approaching someone with the intent to manipulate or change them, they will feel it. If, however, you are looking to be honest and helpful then they will feel that too. Take time before you start this process to run through Steps 1–2 from the second half of this book to ensure you are seeing clearly and have the right information before endeavoring to have these potentially tough conversations.

Telling someone you like them

Telling someone you like them in the world of happy is fairly simple. It takes courage to say it, but even more courage to simply let the chips fall where they will. Remember, we aren't telling someone we like them to force them to confess their love for us. We don't expect anything in return. We are simply being honest because that is how we want to define our relationships. Here is an example of how you might open up a conversation to tell someone you like them.

- “Honesty is super important to me and so I want to tell you how I feel about you. I like you. I really enjoy being around you and I want to keep getting to know you better to see where things could go. Would you be open to going out with me (or continue going out with me)? If not, no problem, I just wanted to be sure you were clear on where I am.”

Breaking up with someone

When breaking up with someone, it can be so tempting to try and soften the blow. We want to manage the other person's feelings and how they see us. Remember, the other person is a person. This means that they are responsible

for managing their own feelings. You cannot and should not try to control their response or manipulate them. This is why I advocate for a straightforward and quick breakup.

- “I know it might come as a shock, but I can’t continue to date you. I feel that we both need to move on. If you would like to stay friends, that is great, but I will give you space until you decide. I am so sorry.”

The other person will likely want to find out why you are breaking up with them. I suggest being honest about your feelings without accusing them or bringing up their faults. Simply and clearly state that you feel that it’s not the right relationship for you and that you need to move on.

Avoid telling them they are amazing or wonderful; this contradicts what you are doing. There is no need to complement or degrade them; you are talking about your experience only.

If the person begins to try and talk you out of the breakup, it's time to hold firm and walk away. Reiterate that you're not feeling committed to the relationship and that you want to move on. I know this might seem strange or cold at first, but there is nothing the person can say that will change your mind. In fact, even though they might not see it, you are trying to be compassionate by not feeding into their own need to be right. By staying true to yourself in this crucial moment, you will free both you and them from unnecessary emotional struggle.

Letting down someone who likes you

Letting someone down can be difficult. Like breaking up, we could feel the need to manage their feelings. You might consider something like this:

- “Thank you for the compliment; I am so flattered that you like me. I do not feel the same about you. I am sorry if this hurts your feelings. I want to be honest so both of us can move forward.”

The other person may try to convince you otherwise or ask you to give them a chance. You can follow that up with a simple “no.”

Preparing what you need to say

Notice the three essential components of each example. These components can be used to improve your communication and help you prepare what you need to say.

1. I use “I” statements, not “you” statements. I am not trying to accuse the other person. Accusing someone will put up their defenses and make the conversation much harder.
2. The sentences are concise. I don’t want to beat around the bush. Long and drawn-out explanations complicate our communication and put at risk the objective of the conversation.
3. The message is clear. Each sentence is calculated to communicate exactly what I need and give the other person the most necessary information. I don’t have to worry about getting the message across and the other person isn’t left guessing.

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